

To: County of Vulcan Council

April 7, 2026

RE: Public Hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 Objection

I am writing to formally request that the public hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 be deemed invalid for the following reasons:

1. The hearing did not provide a fair or reasonable opportunity for meaningful public participation.
2. The County of Vulcan introduced in its online meeting agenda package a major scope change to the project that was not spoken to by the County nor the proponent. There was new material information contained in this submission and no opportunity for participants to become aware of or comment upon these new items. The County did not provide the Applicant's submission in advance nor make the meeting attendees aware of its existence. The hearing did not have any meaningful discussion on this change which is directly related to the land use re-designation.
3. The County of Vulcan has erred in not including the land use associated with the project's associated pumping station and pipeline in this Bylaw. The sitting setbacks in the actual zoning designation were not met by the application and should be denied due to the proximity of the Travers Reservoir and recreational area.

Public Hearing Dated April 1st, 2026

I object to the manner in which the public hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 was conducted.

The hearing did not provide a fair or reasonable opportunity for meaningful public participation. Due to insufficient venue capacity in the main Council Chamber, approximately forty plus attendees were directed to an overflow room where audio quality was extremely poor and no visual component of the presentations was provided until partway through the hearing. As a result, individuals in that room were unable to adequately hear or follow all of the discussion points.

This lack of access to the Council Chamber and poor audio/video in the overflow room caused frustration and led several attendees to leave the hearing prematurely. Importantly, some of those individuals intended to provide verbal submissions but were effectively prevented from doing so due to these conditions.

Public hearings are a critical component of the decision-making process and must be conducted in a manner that is transparent, accessible, and procedurally fair. In this case, the limitations in space and the failure to provide adequate audio-visual access meant that a portion of the public was effectively excluded from participating. This undermines the integrity of the hearing process and raises serious concerns regarding procedural fairness under the Municipal Government Act and the County's own Public Participation Policy.

Given these circumstances, I respectfully request that:

- The public hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 be deemed invalid;
- A new public hearing be scheduled which would be additive to the April 1st participation with full opportunity for everyone to present old and new information;
- The County ensure that the venue can accommodate anticipated attendance;
- Adequate audio and visual access be provided in all areas, including any overflow spaces if required;
- Consideration be given for a portion of the hearing to be in the evening to accommodate those people whose jobs do not allow them access during the day or those that must travel from outside of Vulcan.

Major Change of Power Supply Scope Not Discussed

The project scope in first reading called for power sourced from the grid, with backup-diesel powered generation and battery energy storage intended for emergency use only.

In the Public Hearing Notification Package and in the April 1, 2025 Council Agenda Background & Proposal (pg. 2 of 96), the Vulcan County again stated the project as having “backup diesel power generators” only.

Pg. 20 of 96 the Palliser Grid Public Hearing Submission now states that “Palliser Grid plans to bring its own generation capacity”. This is due to “facilities with their own generation pay as low as 1%” provincial levy. It is also most likely due to recent events whereas:

*The province’s current **peak electricity demand** is about 12 gigawatts. In the last 18 months, the Alberta Utilities Commission (AUC) has fielded requests for large-load connection to the grid for more than 16 GW. In an attempt to manage the load on the grid, the Alberta Electric System Operator (AESO) has created a **temporary cap** of 1,200 megawatts for big projects. It has already allocated that entire amount to just two data centres near Edmonton.*

*With the cap reached, that leaves 37 proposed data-centre projects asking for a combined 19 GW of power, almost double the province’s current generation. These projects will either have to build their own sources of power generation, or wait for new transmission lines — **a process that could take close to a decade**. Source: <https://ucalgary.ca/sustainability/mobilizing-alberta/climate-action-blogs/will-ai-data-centres-raise-water-and-power-use-alberta>*

Neither Vulcan County nor Palliser Grid made the hearing attendants aware of this major change of scope - **continuous power generation** on site. The County did not provide the Applicant’s submission in advance or at the Public Hearing nor make the meeting attendees aware of its existence.

This represents a significant change to the scope and impacts of the project, including but not limited to air emissions, noise, and land use compatibility. This information was not disclosed during the public hearing, and therefore the public and decision-makers were not given a fair opportunity to evaluate the true impacts and provide appropriate feedback as it relates to the land use designation.

As there was no public participation on this major change, a new public hearing should be conducted on this basis alone. Public hearings—especially for land use—are required to be transparent and allow for meaningful participation.

Land Use for the Associated Pump Station and Pipeline Not Contemplated

The County of Vulcan has erred in not including the land use associated with the pumping station and the associated pipeline in this Bylaw. Palliser Grid has stated the water requirements for this project are to be taken from the Travers Reservoir, but have not provided details nor location of the pump station or the pipeline. The pump station will most likely need to be proximal to the Travers Reservoir which is contemplated in the Vulcan County Reservoir Area Structure Plan. The County must evaluate a land use amendment based on the full scope and impacts of the proposed development.

The pumping station is an essential component of the proposed development and was not disclosed, evaluated, or included in the land use decision. Its location near the reservoir, recreational areas, and environmentally-sensitive habitat introduces significant environmental and land use impacts that were not considered. This represents a fundamental flaw in both the application and the approval process.

This is a major land use omission and another reason for a new public hearing on this matter. The land use for this project needs to be reviewed as a whole and not piecemeal.

I also request that this correspondence be included in the official record for Bylaw 2026-007.

Thank you for your attention to this matter. I look forward to your response.

Sincerely,



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On Behalf of the LBR Data Center Committee

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